

WORKSHEET

The God who remembers and calls

Torah: Genesis 21:1–34 · **Haftarah:** 1 Samuel 1:1–2:10 · **Gospel:** Matthew 24:29–36

On Yom Teruah God remembers: He visits Sarah (Gen. 21:1) and remembers Hannah (1 Sam. 1:19) — the classic reason these very texts are the day's readings. The trumpet blast wakes us to hear: what we received is entrusted to us and carries a calling; giving back is the wakeful act of one who knows from whom it came.

How to use this sheet

Work from top to bottom: first observe (A1), then weigh (A2), then diagnose (A3), and only then summarise (A4). The direction — receiving or waked and called — is the horizon, not the starting point.

Basic data

Parashah / scope: Yom Teruah — Genesis 21:1–34. Haftarah: 1 Samuel 1:1–2:10.

Flanking reading and status: Matthew 24:29–36 — New Testament reflection, used confessionally (not as peshat). Audience: study group / congregation.

A1. Text blocks and peshat

Block	What it says (peshat)	Keywords / contrast	Open question
Gen. 21:1–8	The LORD visits Sarah as said; Isaac born and circumcised; Sarah laughs for joy.	pakad · laughter that spreads	Why does it begin with the Word, not the child?
Gen. 21:9–21	Ishmael metzachek; sending away; God hears the lad's voice	metzachek · God hears	Is this comfort, alarm, or both?

	in the wilderness.		
1 Sam. 1:1–20	Hannah's grief, silent prayer, misread by Eli; God remembers; Samuel born.	zachar · being heard	What does it mean that God hears what no one hears?
1 Sam. 1:21–2:10	Hannah gives Samuel back; her song of reversal and kingship.	giving back · reversal	Is giving back weakness or strength?
Matt. 24:29–36	The Son of Man, the great trumpet, the gathering; the hour is hidden.	trumpet · unknown hour	How do you watch without knowing the hour?

A2. Connecting hypotheses

Hypothesis 1 (one axis): the centre is Source alone — all is gift, and the human receives. The response stays in the background.

Hypothesis 2 (relation): the centre is the relation Source ↔ Will — God remembers, hears and gives, and therefore the human is waked and called to hear, to receive and to give back.

Which explains the most data with the least strain? Hypothesis 2. It explains why the day is called *teruah* (an imperative, not mere gift), why Hannah makes a vow and gives back, and why Matthew 24 runs out to “watch.” Hypothesis 1 leaves *teruah* and the giving-back unexplained.

What would refute this reading? If *teruah* were pure comfort and Hannah's song a sweet thank-you, the weight would lie with Source alone.

A3. Four axes

Axis	Text anchors	Diagnosis	Open anomaly
Source	21:1,17 · 1 Sam. 1:19–20	Load-bearing. God visits, remembers, hears and gives.	Why the long delay?
Will	Lev. 23:24 · 1 Sam. 1:11,27–28 · Matt. 24:42	Load-bearing. Waking, hearing, giving back, watching.	Where does waking become grasping (Ishmael)?

Coherence	21:6 · 1 Sam. 1:13	Thin. Heart and visible action align.	—
Trajectory	21:12–13 · 1 Sam. 2:10 · Matt. 24:31	Rising, serving. Promise → kingship → last trumpet.	Pointer or core?

A4. Movement

What is unmasked? The anxious holding-on as though we had made it — and the subtle variant “God needs my help” (Ishmael), where we still believe the promise but seize the process.

What frame does the text put in its place? The God who remembers, hears and gives — and who wakes us with a sound: receive as gift, and give back into His service.

What concrete response and formation follow? Truly hearing instead of growing used to it; giving back as a wakeful act (Hannah); and watching with open hands, even without knowing the hour (Matt. 24).

Core sentence: The sound wakes us — receive what is entrusted to you, and lay it open in the hand of the One who hears and remembers.

Horizon (ground, not the week's theme): the last trumpet (Matt. 24:31) — the same God who remembered Sarah and Hannah calls His children together at the end.